

Scenario Planning: How We Compare

A side-by-side look at scenario & what-if planning in our forecasting grid versus the leading enterprise planning and decision-intelligence platforms.

Our Solution — In-grid Scenario Drawer

Anaplan

SAP (SAC + IBP)

Pigment

Aera Technology

Where we win, where we're at parity, where we trail

Our scenario planning is **embedded directly in the forecasting grid** as a progressive bottom drawer. That in-context model, business-semantic drivers, and in-table goal-seek are genuine differentiators. The enterprise incumbents lead on **calculation scale, governance/versioning, and predictive + agentic AI**.

WE LEAD

- **In-context planning** — scenarios live inside the grid; no separate modeling app or context switch.
- **Business-semantic drivers** — "Price Concession Depth: Match Competitor", not raw model formulas.
- **In-table goal-seek** — edit a KPI target and the driver back-solves instantly.
- **Round-trip to the plan** — "Show in grid" surfaces impacted cells + deltas to review & save.

AT PARITY

- **Side-by-side comparison** — named scenarios as columns with deltas vs baseline.
- **Decision-support charts** — revenue, trade-off, and target-attainment views.
- **Driver-based what-if** — levers recompute dependent KPIs live.
- **Approval-aware workflow** — promote / alerts patterns exist in the app.

WE TRAIL

- **Calculation engine at scale** — multidimensional, enterprise-volume modeling.
- **Versioning & governance** — auditable lifecycle, lineage, access control.
- **Predictive ML forecasting** — statistical baselines & accuracy measures.
- **Agentic / NL AI** — generate scenarios & recommend actions conversationally.

The one-line positioning

The incumbents are **modeling platforms you plan in**; ours is **planning where the work already happens**. Our defensible edge is the **last mile of decision-making** — driver semantics a business user understands, goal-seek in the same table they read, and a one-click path from "what if" to reviewable edits in the live plan. The strategic gaps to close are engine scale, governance, and AI depth.

The in-grid Scenario Drawer

Scenario planning is a persistent bottom drawer on the forecasting grid. It uses **progressive disclosure**: a collapsed strip for quick levers, expanding to a full comparison workspace — the planner never leaves the grid they were reading.

Scenarios

Growth Disruptor

Growth

+12%

Price

-2%

Volume

+9%

Show in grid

Collapsed strip — active scenario selector, quick levers (Growth / Price / Volume), and "Show in grid".

Scenarios

Growth Disruptor

Growth

+12%

Price

-2%

Volume

+9%

Show in grid

KPI

● Baseline

● Market Defender

● Efficiency Maximizer

● Growth Disruptor

Current Trend

Conservative · Protective

Profit-Led

Aggressive · Signal-Led

DRIVERS

Price Concession

Hold (0%)

Match Competitor (6%)

Hold (0%)

Aggressive (12%)

Target Margin

Plan Target (22%)

Protect (24%)

Stretch (19%)

Plan Target (22%)

Rebate Tier

Tier 1: 5%

Tier 1: 5%

Tier 2: 10%

Tier 3: 15%

OUTCOMES

Sales Agreement Quantity	85,000 units	87,567 units ↑ 3.0%	89,301 units ↑ 5.1%	103,768 units ↑ 22.1%
SA Qty Lift vs Baseline	0.0%	3.0% ↑ 3.0%	5.1% ↑ 5.1%	22.1% ↑ 22.1%
Sales Agreement Revenue	\$255.0K	\$270.5K ↑ 6.1%	\$283.7K ↑ 11.2%	\$279.9K ↑ 9.8%
Opportunity Quantity	110,500 units	113,837 units ↑ 3.0%	116,091 units ↑ 5.1%	134,898 units ↑ 22.1%
Opportunity Revenue	\$331.5K	\$351.7K ↑ 6.1%	\$368.8K ↑ 11.2%	\$363.9K ↑ 9.8%
Order Quantity	72,250 units	74,432 units ↑ 3.0%	75,906 units ↑ 5.1%	88,203 units ↑ 22.1%
Order Revenue	\$210.0K	\$222.8K ↑ 6.1%	\$233.6K ↑ 11.2%	\$230.5K ↑ 9.8%
Price Concession (Cost)	\$5.0K	\$5.2K ↑ 3.0%	\$5.3K ↑ 5.1%	\$6.2K ↑ 24.5%
Cost per Incremental Unit	\$1.50/unit	\$1.50/unit ↓ 0.2%	\$1.49/unit ↓ 0.5%	\$1.47/unit ↓ 2.2%
Net Profit Margin	18.5%	20.8% ↑ 2.3%	23.1% ↑ 4.6%	16.6% ↓ 1.9%
% of Sales Agreement Target	102.0%	108.2% ↑ 6.2%	113.5% ↑ 11.5%	112.0% ↑ 10.0%
Cannibalization (Adjacent Line)	\$0	-\$640 ↓ \$640	-\$960 ↓ \$960	-\$3.8K ↓ \$3.8K

\$240K

\$260K

\$280K

\$300K

\$320K

\$340K

Jan

Feb

Mar

Apr

May

Jun

Jul

Aug

● Baseline

● Market Defender

● Efficiency Maximizer

● Growth Disruptor

Qty vs Margin Trade-off (bubble = concession cost)

24%

23%

22%

21%

20%

19%

18%

17%

16%

81,246

85,000

90,000

95,000

100,000

105,000

107,522

Net Margin

Sales Agreement Quantity

Target Revenue Attainment (dashed line = 100% target)

120%

100%

80%

60%

40%

20%

0%

Baseline

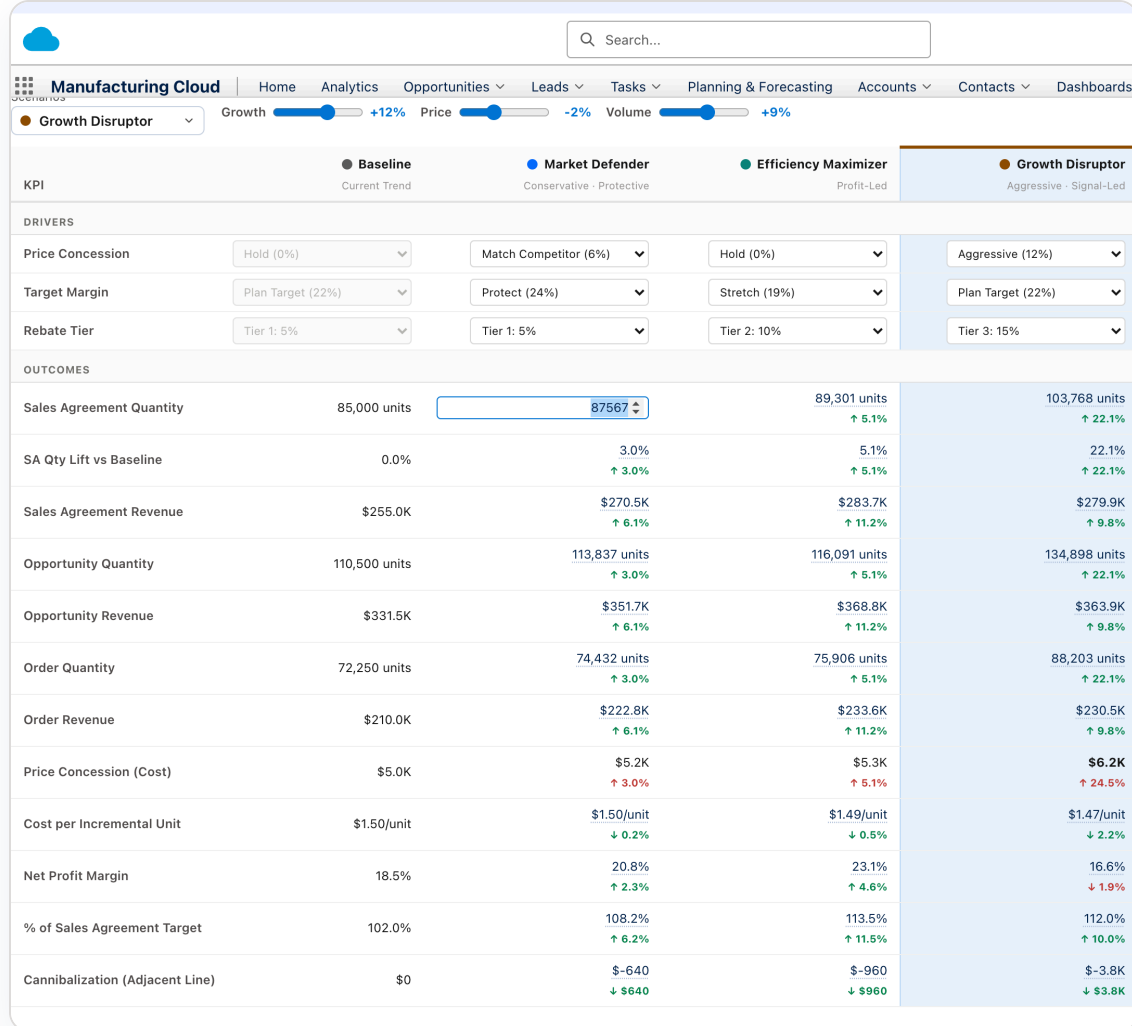
Market Defender

Efficiency Maximizer

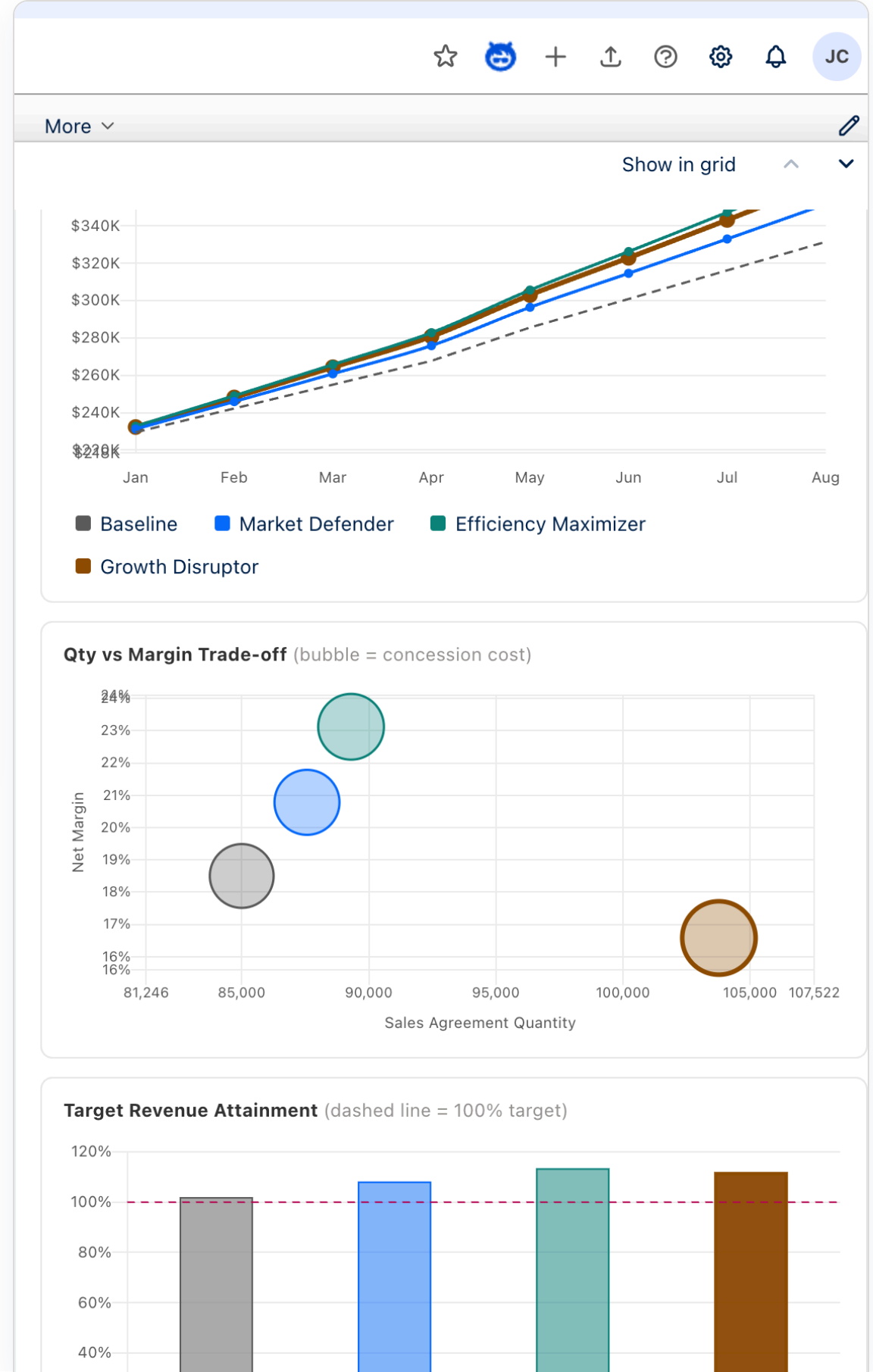
Growth Disruptor

Expanded workspace — named scenarios as columns, business-semantic driver dropdowns, a full KPI comparison matrix with favorable/unfavorable deltas, and three decision-support charts.

Goal-seek & decision-support charts



Goal-seek — KPI cells are editable. Type a target (e.g. a revenue figure) and the relevant driver back-solves via a bisection solver, recomputing every dependent KPI.





Charts — revenue comparison (line), qty-vs-margin trade-off (bubble = concession cost), and target-revenue attainment (bar with 100% reference). Clicking a series focuses that scenario in the table.

What makes this distinctive

- 1 No context switch.** The comparison overlays the same grid; "Show in grid" writes the scenario back as reviewable pending edits with deltas and a save action.
- 2 Semantics over formulas.** Levers read as business choices ("Match Competitor", "Protect Margin", "Rebate Tier"), not cell math.
- 3 Goal-seek in place.** Back-solving lives inside the comparison table itself — no separate solver dialog.

Anaplan — connected planning at enterprise scale

Anaplan · Scenario Comparison Board

Representative

Version: FY26 Baseline ▾

Downturn ▾

Aggressive ▾

+ New version

Switchover: Apr FY26

Driver / KPI	Baseline	Downturn	Aggressive
Volume growth %	3.0%	-4.0%	9.0%
Price index	100	96	103
Revenue (\$M)	612	548	691
Op. margin %	18.5	15.1	20.4
Cash (\$M)	210	171	248

PlanIQ forecast

Sensitivity

CoModeler agent

Representative Anaplan pattern: versions/scenarios managed centrally, unlimited what-if comparison boards, ML (PlanIQ) and 2026 role-based AI agents.

What they do well

- **Hyperblock / Polaris / HyperModel engines** — massive multidimensional models, real-time recalculation, "granularity without sacrificing performance".
- **Versions as first-class** — admins create/name versions, set switchover dates; unlimited scenario comparison + automated variance.
- **Driver-based & sensitivity** — market-leading for strategic finance; board-ready comparison dashboards.
- **AI** — PlanIQ / Predictive Insights (ML) plus 2026 agentic layer (CoModeler, NL scenario generation, role agents).
- **Governance** — ALM, decision lineage back to source systems, auditability.

vs Us: Anaplan leads decisively on engine scale, versioning/governance and AI. We lead on **time-to-value and in-context UX** — Anaplan typically needs modeling expertise / partners; ours is usable by a business planner with zero setup.

SAP — SAC (xP&A) + IBP Harmonized Scenarios

SAP IBP · Planner Workspace — Scenario Lifecycle

Representative

Create

▶ Simulate

▮ Compare

✓ Promote to baseline

Shine-through: on

Auto-delete: +365d

Key figure	Baseline	Scenario A	Δ
Demand (units)	84,000	90,300	+7.5%
Supply / receipts	82,100	88,900	+8.3%
Projected stock	12,400	9,800	-21%
Revenue (\$M)	255	272	+6.7%

SAC value-driver tree

Excel add-in

 Joule

Representative SAP pattern (IBP 2602/2605): one scenario spans key figures + orders — create, simulate, compare, and promote to baseline with controlled shine-through; SAC adds value-driver-tree what-if.

What they do well

- **Harmonized Scenario Management (IBP)** — unified lifecycle across time-series key figures *and* orders in one framework; create without simulating first, branch from a simulation, promote results (incl. orders) to baseline.
- **Controlled shine-through** — precise control of how baseline changes flow into scenarios; scheduled deletion prevents scenario sprawl.
- **One-click simulation** — statistical forecast in simulation mode, discard in one click; now in the Excel add-in too.
- **SAC (xP&A)** — value driver trees, versions (public/private), data actions, predictive.
- **Deep ERP integration & Joule AI**; enterprise governance.

vs Us: SAP leads on lifecycle rigor (promote-to-baseline, shine-through, orders+key-figures) and ERP depth. We lead on **approachability** — SAP's power sits behind planning-area configuration and a steeper UI; ours is immediate and grid-native.

Pigment — modern Scenarios vs governed Versions

Pigment · Compare Scenarios

Representative

☒ Base

☒ Best case

☒ Worst case

☐ + Scenario

Compare to snapshot ▾

Metric	Base ⓘ	Best ⓘ	Worst ⓘ
New bookings	\$4.2M	\$5.1M	\$3.4M
Headcount	310	340	285
Gross margin	72%	74%	69%
Runway (mo)	18	22	13

f Per-scenario formulas

Copy inputs

Predictions

Representative Pigment pattern: multi-select scenarios shown side-by-side, each with independent inputs/formulas; Version dimension for governed cycles; Predictions for ML.

What they do well

- **Two-tier model** — *Scenarios* for fast ad-hoc what-if (best/worst, sensitivity, short-term) vs a *Version dimension* for governed, auditable, repeatable cycles.
- **Compare Scenarios** — check multiple scenarios to view side-by-side on grids/boards; edit inputs **and formulas independently per scenario**; copy inputs between scenarios.
- **Compare-to-snapshot** — live plan vs a frozen snapshot without duplicating data.
- **Predictions** — ML forecasting with accuracy measures & model comparison.
- **Modern, business-user-friendly UI** — the closest peer to our design philosophy.

vs Us: The nearest match on **UX and side-by-side comparison**. Pigment goes deeper (per-scenario formulas, snapshots, ML). We counter with **in-grid embedding, business-semantic drivers, and in-table goal-seeking** that Pigment doesn't surface as directly.

Aera — agentic decision intelligence

◆ Aera Decision Cloud · Simulate & Recommend

Representative

"Demand for SKU-118 just spiked 12% in the West. What should we do?"

Aera analyzed live data across 3 systems and simulated 4 responses:

Option	Fill rate	Margin Δ	Cost
Expedite from DC-2	98%	-1.2%	\$41k
Reallocate East stock	95%	+0.3%	\$12k
Do nothing	86%	0%	\$0

Recommended:

Reallocate East stock — best margin at lowest cost.
Explainable · traceable to source · execute on approval.

Representative Aera pattern: conversational "situation → simulation → recommended action", with explainable trade-offs and governed one-click execution.

What they do well

- **Scenario & simulation models** — what-if analysis that quantifies trade-offs and assesses outcomes *before execution*, composed from rules + AI/ML + live data.
- **Agentic reasoning** — go from question to validated action in one conversation (2026); surfaces adjacent risks/opportunities.
- **Decision Data Model** — "decision memory" learns from outcomes to improve future recommendations.
- **Governed execution** — auto-execute or route for approval; fully auditable. Excel-like self-service Workspaces + real-time Calc engine.
- **2026 Gartner MQ Leader — Decision Intelligence.**

vs Us: Different category — Aera is a **decision-automation layer** (mostly supply-chain/ops) that *acts*, not a planning grid. It far outpaces us on autonomy & recommendations. We are a **human-driven planning surface**; the lesson to borrow is **recommend-and-explain**.

Scenario planning — scored comparison

●●●● Strong / market-leading ●●●○ Solid ●●○○ Partial ●○○○ Minimal ○○○○ None

Capability	Ours	Anaplan	SAP	Pigment	Aera
In-context / embedded in the grid Plan without leaving the working view	●●●●	●●○○	●●○○	●●●○	●●○○
Side-by-side scenario comparison	●●●○	●●●●	●●●○	●●●●	●●●○
Business-semantic drivers Lever a business user reads directly	●●●●	●●●○	●●○○	●●●○	●●●○
Goal-seek / back-solve in place	●●●○	●●●○	●●○○	●●○○	●●●●
Real-time recalculation	●●●○	●●●●	●●●○	●●●○	●●●●
Calculation engine at scale Multidimensional, enterprise volume	●○○○	●●●●	●●●●	●●●○	●●●●
Scenario lifecycle Create · branch · promote-to-baseline · retire	●●○○	●●●●	●●●●	●●●○	●●●○
Versioning · governance · audit lineage	●○○○	●●●●	●●●●	●●●●	●●●○
Predictive ML forecasting	○○○○	●●●●	●●●○	●●●○	●●●●
Generative / agentic AI & recommendations	○○○○	●●●○	●●○○	●●○○	●●●●
Decision-support charts	●●●○	●●●●	●●●○	●●●●	●●●○
Round-trip to plan as reviewable edits	●●●●	●●●○	●●●○	●●○○	●●●○
Time-to-value / business-user accessibility	●●●●	●●○○	●●○○	●●●○	●●○○

Scores are a directional assessment for scenario/what-if planning specifically (not whole-platform breadth), based on public documentation as of mid-2026 and the current state of our prototype.

Closing the gap without losing the edge

Protect & press our advantages

- **In-context drawer** — keep scenario work glued to the grid; this is our identity.
- **Business-semantic drivers** — expand the driver library (discounting, channel mix, promo) as curated dropdowns.
- **Goal-seek** — extend from single-driver back-solve to multi-driver, constrained solves.
- **Round-trip to plan** — the "Show in grid → reviewable edits → save/promote" loop is uniquely tight; make it the headline.

Gaps to close (priority order)

- **Scenario lifecycle & versioning** — name, save, clone, and promote scenarios with an audit trail (table-stakes vs all four).
- **Predictive baseline** — an ML/statistical forecast as the starting scenario (Anaplan PlanIQ / Pigment Predictions parity).
- **Recommend-and-explain** — surface a suggested scenario + rationale (borrow from Aera), short of full auto-execution.
- **Governance** — access control & lineage for when scenarios feed the official plan.

Now Solidify the core

- Persist & name scenarios (save/clone/delete).
- Assumptions saved per scenario; audit of who changed what.
- Multi-driver goal-seek with bounds.

Next Add intelligence

- ML predictive baseline scenario.
- Sensitivity / tornado view across drivers.
- "Suggested scenario" with explainable rationale.

Later Enterprise-grade

- Versioning + governance + lineage.
- Scale the calc model beyond the current grid.
- Agent that drafts & compares scenarios on request.

Bottom line: We don't need to out-engine Anaplan or out-automate Aera to win the moment. Our wedge is the **decision last-mile** — the fastest path from a business question to a reviewed change in the live plan. Fund lifecycle + a predictive baseline + recommend-and-explain, and we reach parity on the fundamentals while keeping a UX lead none of them have in-grid.

Method & sources

Method

- **Our screens** are live screenshots of the working prototype's scenario drawer.
- **Competitor screens** are **representative mockups** rebuilt from public product documentation and release notes — they illustrate the interaction pattern, not the exact pixels, and carry no copyrighted assets.
- Scores are scoped to scenario / what-if planning, not full-platform breadth.

Primary sources (public, mid-2026)

- Anaplan — Platform & "Scenario planning and analysis"; Polaris / HyperModel; PlanIQ; 2026 agentic announcements.
- SAP — IBP 2602 / 2605 release notes (Harmonized Scenario Management); SAP Learning "Scenarios"; SAP Analytics Cloud xP&A.
- Pigment — KB "Versions & Scenarios", "Compare Scenarios", "Compare to Snapshot"; Predictions.
- Aera Technology — Aera Decision Cloud, Multi-Engine Orchestration, Workspaces, 2026 agentic reasoning news; Gartner Peer Insights.

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